



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
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E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 10 – English Verbs

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Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of lesson 10

- i. To make students aware of the existence of the verb types;
- ii. To familiarize students with the different types of verbs and show them how to use them appropriately.

1. Definition:

Verbs are the most important words in a sentence. There are three types of verbs: *action verbs*, *linking verbs*, and *helping verbs*.

1. **action verbs**: they have this name because they show action. **Action verbs** are the most common verbs in English.

ex: * The dog **barked** at the man.

* **Sit** down, please!

* The wolf **ran** across the sand.

Action verbs can be either transitive or intransitive.

a. Transitive Verbs: A transitive verb always has a noun that receives the action of the verb, called the direct object.

e.g. Laurissa **raises** her hand.

The verb is raises. Her hand is the object receiving the verb's action. Therefore, raises is a transitive verb.

b. Intransitive Verbs: An intransitive verb never has a direct or an indirect object. Although an intransitive verb may be followed by an adverb or adverbial phrase, there is no object to receive its action. e.g. Laurissa **rises** slowly from her seat.

The verb is rises. The phrase, slowly from her seat, modifies the verb, but no object receives the action.

2. Linking Verbs

A linking verb connects the subject of a sentence to a noun or adjective that renames or describes the subject. This noun or adjective is called the **subject complement**.

EX: *Jason **became** a business major.

The verb 'became' links the subject 'Jason' to its complement 'a business major'.

*Lisa **is** in love with Jason.

The verb '**is**' links the subject 'Lisa' to the subject complement 'in love with Jason' (describing Lisa). The most common linking verb is the verb 'to be' in all of its forms (am, are, is, was, were, etc.).

'To become' and 'to seem' are always linking verbs. Other verbs may be linking verbs in some cases and action verbs in others:

to appear, to feel, to look, to remain, to stay, to taste, to continue, to grow, to prove, to sound, to smell and to turn.

LINKING: * Libby **appeared** happy. (Appeared links Libby to the subject complement, happy.) ACTION: Deon **suddenly** appeared. (Here, appeared is an intransitive action verb.)

3. **Helping Verbs**

Helping verbs are used before action or linking verbs to convey additional information regarding aspects of possibility (*can, could, etc.*) or time (*was, did, has, etc.*). The main verb with its accompanying helping verb is called a **verb phrase**.

Ex: * He **is** (helping verb) **going** (main verb) to Florida.

*The trip **might** (helping verb) **be** (main verb) dangerous.

The following words, called **modals**, always function as helping verbs:

will	shall	must	may	can
would	should	ought to	might	could

In addition, the following forms of the verbs *to be*, *to do*, and *to have* sometimes serve as helping verbs. (Note: In other cases, they may serve as action or linking verbs.)

was	have	had	do	being	be	am
were	is	has	does	did	been	are

Ex:

HELPING: Jana **is moving** to a new house.

LINKING: Jana **is** ready to go.

Time for practice:

Pick out the **verbs** in these sentences and tell whether they are **action, helping** or **linking verbs**

1. A little morning rain foretells a pleasant day.
2. The soldiers look tired.
3. His voice has turned towards childish treble pipes.
4. They have their exits and entrances.
5. One man in his time will play many parts.

References

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